

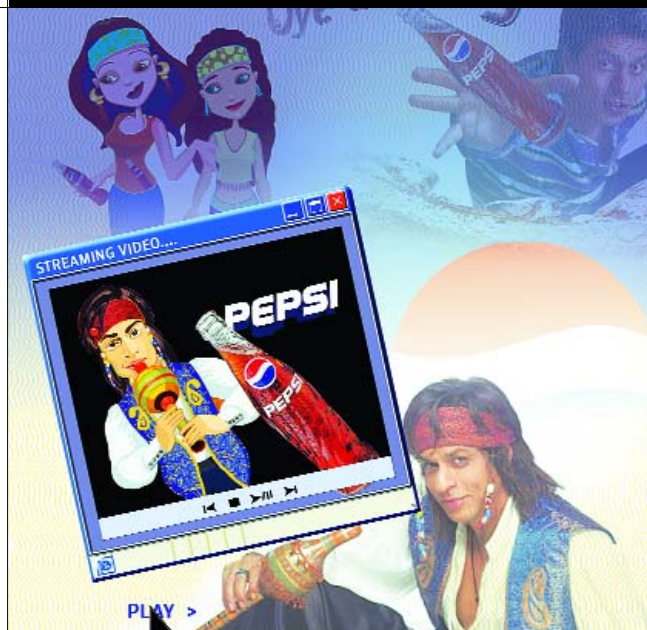


Nawal Ahuja
Co-founder and Director,
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The trend of using the Internet as the 'first point of interaction' with a consumer is increasingly catching on. Fortunately, the better quality PCs and increased connection speeds allow for streaming on a relatively larger number of PCs. Using cross media combinations such as TV-cum-print or print-cum-outdoor to launch new campaigns is an age-old phenomenon but the TV-cum-Internet combo is as an effective medium.

Streaming content is a powerful way to target the audience. Many movie production houses worldwide use it to promote their offerings. Using the same technology, we are in the process of launching a service on our website where TV channels can air promos of their latest shows and introduce their wares to the ad fraternity.

The Internet is primarily a youngster's medium. It's interactive—a feature no other medium offers. A well-executed ad on the Net can help the brand provided it's seamlessly



YOU SAW IT

Product commercials in the form of 'webisodes' are launched online prior to being shown on the television. Is the uptake for online advertisements better than that of other media?



Vishal Chinchankar
Business Director,
mOne Worldwide
(Media Buying Agency)

Playing commercials first on the Internet before airing them on the TV is a concept that's still in its initial stage in India. Nevertheless, this trend is catching on rather quickly as there are Web sites that offer this option.

Some major advertisers who use the Internet extensively are dotcoms such as Shaadi.com and Naukri.com. Financial brands such as ICICI and Citibank also use the Internet to advertise as they target individuals with high net worth.

As for youth brands such as MTV and Pepsi, most of their target group comprises the 'Upper Sec A1' or youth from urban centres, hence, online advertising is a preferred option.

Currently, online advertising is popular among media planners and clients and they are exploring innovative ways of interacting with consumers.

The Internet is the only medium that provides for engaging and interactive content; take for instance, the recently aired Pepsi Web commercial. Moreover, the industry has seen a consistent growth year after year in online advertising as advertisers realised its tremendous potential. I see more innovative trends emerging in the sphere of Internet advertising.